Linux `vim` Command Notes

The `vim` **editor** (Vi IMproved) is a powerful text editor available in most Linux systems. It is an enhanced version of the older `vi` editor and is widely used for editing code and configuration files.

🔹 Starting Vim

```
vim filename
```

- Opens `filename` in vim. - If the file does not exist, vim creates it.

Example:

```
vim notes.txt
```

👉Opens (or creates) `notes.txt`.

🔹 Vim Modes

Vim has multiple modes, the most important are:

1. **Normal mode** (default) → For navigation & commands.
2. **Insert mode** → For editing text.
3. **Command mode** → For saving, quitting, and executing commands.

🔹 Switching Between Modes

- `i` → Enter Insert mode (before cursor)
- `a` → Enter Insert mode (after cursor)
- `o` → Open new line below and enter Insert mode
- `Esc` → Back to Normal mode

Example:

```
(Press i)
Hello, this is my text.
(Press Esc to return to Normal mode)
```

🔹 Saving and Quitting

- `:w` → Save file
- `:q` → Quit vim
- `:wq` → Save and quit
- `:q!` → Quit without saving

Example:

```
:wq
```

👉Saves the file and exits.

🔹 Basic Editing

- `x` → Delete character under cursor
- `dd` → Delete whole line
- `yy` → Copy (yank) a line
- `p` → Paste after cursor
- `u` → Undo last change
- `Ctrl + r` → Redo undone change

Example:

```
File Content:
Hello World
This is Linux

Action:
Place cursor on "Hello World" and press dd

Result:
This is Linux
```

🔹 Navigation

- `h` → Move left
- `l` → Move right
- `k` → Move up
- `j` → Move down
- `0` → Move to beginning of line
- `$` → Move to end of line
- `gg` → Go to first line
- `G` → Go to last line

Example:

```
File Content:
Line 1
Line 2
Line 3

Command: gg
👉 Cursor moves to "Line 1"

Command: G
👉 Cursor moves to "Line 3"
```

🔹 Search and Replace

- `/word` → Search for "word"
- `n` → Go to next match
- `:%s/old/new/g` → Replace all occurrences of "old" with "new"

Example:

```
File Content:
Hello Linux
Hello World

Command: :%s/Hello/Hi/g

Result:
Hi Linux
Hi World
```

🔹 Working with Multiple Files

```
vim file1.txt file2.txt
```

- `:n` → Open next file - `:prev` → Open previous file

Example:

```
vim file1.txt file2.txt
```

👉Opens both files in vim.

🔹 Visual Mode

- `v` → Start visual selection
- `V` → Select whole line
- `y` → Yank (copy) selection
- `d` → Delete selection

Example:

```
File Content:
Line A
Line B
Line C

Action: Place cursor on "Line A", press V, move down, press y
👉 Copies Line A and Line B
```

🔹 Split Windows

- `:split file2.txt` → Horizontal split
- `:vsplit file2.txt` → Vertical split
- `Ctrl + w, w` → Switch between windows

Example:

```
:split file2.txt
```

👉Opens file2.txt in a split window.

🔹 Exit Vim

- Save and quit: `:wq`
- Quit without saving: `:q!`
- Quit all files: `:qa`

Quick Summary of Commands

Action	Command
Enter insert mode	`i`, `a`, `o`
Save file	`:w`

Action	Command
Quit	`:q`
Save & quit	`:wq`
Quit without saving	`:q!`
Delete line	`dd`
Copy (yank) line	`yy`
Paste	`p`
Undo	`u`
Redo	`Ctrl+r`
Search word	`/word`
Replace all	`:%s/old/new/g`
First line	`gg`
Last line	`G`

👉 Vim is a **powerful editor**: learn the basics (`i`, `Esc`, `:wq`, `dd`, `yy`, `/search`) first, then explore advanced features like visual mode and splits.